



Investigation report

Rejected take-off and runway overrun, Tarlton Springs - Standard investigation

Drafted 05/10/2026

INVESTIGATION WORKFLOW SUITE

Contents

Executive summary	3
Event overview	5
The flight and the crew	5
Before the departure	5
The take-off roll	5
The rejected take-off	6
The stop	6
After the aircraft stopped	6
Outcome	7
Analysis	8
Introduction	8
People	8
Environment	10
Equipment	12
Procedures	13
Organisation	15
Excluded hypotheses	17
Findings summary	19
Contributing factors	19
Other factors that increased risk	19
Other findings	20
Appendices	21
Appendix A: Factor test summary	21
Appendix B: Excluded hypotheses	22
Appendix C: Sources of evidence	23
Appendix D: Investigation activity	24
Distribution	24

Executive summary

On 18/06/2026, Saltbush Air SB512, a 50-seat twin-turboprop registered VH-SBQ, rejected its take-off from runway 09 at Tarlton Springs Aerodrome when two kangaroos moved onto the runway. The captain rejected at 118 kt, 6 kt above V1, and the aircraft struck both animals about one second later. It left the runway end at approximately 21 kt and came to rest at 07:30:57 UTC. It was upright on the extended centreline, 62 m into the 90 m runway end safety area and 28 m short of the ungraded terrain beyond.

None of the 44 passengers, 2 flight crew and 1 cabin crew member was seriously injured. One cabin crew member reported bruising during the precautionary disembarkation. The aircraft was substantially damaged. Three No. 2 propeller blades were beyond limits, the right main gear doors were distorted, both right main tyres had deflated and the lower right fuselage was punctured. Both kangaroos were killed, and the aerodrome was closed for 4 hours 20 minutes.

Two contributions acted together, and neither alone would have taken the aircraft past the runway end. The stop began after V1, whereas the scheduled accelerate-stop distance assumes a stop at or before V1. That distance left a margin of only 67 m. The strike also removed No. 2 reverse, so deceleration was approximately 15% below the certified value.

The kangaroos very likely entered through a failed section of the northern perimeter fence. The aerodrome had deferred its repair, unfunded, at three successive budget rounds. An animal pad through the fence lay on the same side as the carcasses, 138 m before the first. The departure was in full darkness, 5 minutes after the end of civil twilight. The aerodrome's log recorded most kangaroo movement at this time of day. No runway inspection was requested before this first departure after last light. The aerodrome would have carried one out if asked, but no document prompted either crew member to consider it.

The investigation identified these organisational safety issues:

- The operator required a runway inspection before the first departure after last light only at aerodromes listed in Appendix 8A. It listed an aerodrome only after a reported strike. Tarlton Springs had never been listed despite eleven logged sightings of kangaroos on the sealed surface. The control could only be armed by the event it exists to prevent.
- The operator approved the evening service, its first operation into Tarlton Springs after last light, as a schedule change only. It did not reopen route risk assessment RRA-041 or its daylight-only restriction.
- Rejected take-off training presented only aircraft system events, with no preparation for a runway obstruction. The captain stated that he knowingly departed from the procedure because he judged continuing to be worse. The training gap was found, on balance, to have contributed to the decision. The opposing reading was also recorded: that the gap describes the fleet rather than explaining this reject.
- AS-139 10.4.2 requires a documented wildlife hazard management plan only above a size threshold that Tarlton Springs does not meet, so the aerodrome was not in breach. Its wildlife measures therefore had no documented plan, audit trail or owner. This likely contributed.
- Two cabin floor proximity escape path lighting segments were dark because of a failed ballast that the pre-flight test cannot detect. No evacuation was commanded and the cabin lights were on throughout, so this did not contribute. It did increase risk to occupants.

The captain established maximum braking 2 seconds after deciding to reject, against a fleet mean of 3.2 seconds. This very likely reduced the distance travelled into the runway end safety area.

On 26/06/2026 the operator listed Tarlton Springs in Appendix 8A by temporary revision. The aerodrome operator installed a temporary electric wire on 25/06/2026 and funded fence replacement for 09/2026. The investigation makes two recommendations to the operator. It should list aerodromes on wildlife exposure rather than a reported strike. It should also trigger a route risk assessment for any aerodrome it first operates into after last light.

Event overview

The flight and the crew

On 18/06/2026, Saltbush Air SB512 was scheduled from Tarlton Springs Aerodrome to Sydney. The aircraft was a 50-seat twin-turboprop registered VH-SBQ. On board were 44 passengers, 2 flight crew and 1 cabin crew member. It was the last scheduled sector of the day.

The flight crew had signed on at 06:30 local. The Tarlton Springs sector was their fifth of the day. It had been added that morning when the rostered crew reported unfit. In interview the captain said the schedule had run late from about the second sector, after a ground delay in Sydney in the middle of the day. Duty records show the occurrence came 11 hours 00 minutes into a duty planned to finish at 18:35 local. That duty would have run 12 hours 05 minutes, against a maximum of 12 hours 30 minutes for five sectors with that sign-on.

The captain held 8,410 hours total, 2,140 of them on type, and had been in command for 3 years 1 month. The first officer held 1,655 hours total, 405 of them on type. She had flown into Tarlton Springs twice before, on 09/01/2026 and 17/02/2026, both times in daylight. This was her first visit after dark. The first officer was the pilot flying.

Before the departure

The aerodrome operator carried out its daily movement area inspection at 21:35 UTC on 17/06/2026, before the first scheduled arrival. The inspection log recorded the movement area as clear. It was the only runway inspection that day, and no further inspection was carried out or requested.

By the time SB512 was ready to leave, the aerodrome was in darkness. The tower was open, and it was rostered to close at 18:00 local. The doors closed at 07:16 UTC, 40 minutes behind schedule.

Both pilots described a normal take-off brief covering the runway length, the performance figures and the headwind. Each said in interview that animals were not discussed. The first officer said she had checked the flight plan, the charts, the ERSA entry and the company aerodrome brief page for Tarlton Springs. None of them mentioned wildlife.

The take-off was planned at 20,800 kg, flap 10, on dry runway 09, with a 5 kt headwind component. The calculated V1 was 112 kt.

At 07:29:10 the tower cleared SB512 for take-off on runway 09 and passed the wind as 090 at 6 kt. The tower did not offer a runway inspection and the crew did not request one. No wildlife transmission appears on the tower channel in the preceding 90 minutes.

The take-off roll

The first officer called "Power set" at 07:30:02, and the roll began. The two engines were at 98.4% and 98.5% torque, within 0.1% of each other. The flight data shows no caution, warning or engine parameter exceedance during the roll. It also shows a headwind component of 4 to 6 kt throughout and no tailwind at any point.

The captain called eighty knots at 07:30:15. At 07:30:29 he called "V one", with the aircraft at 112 kt.

Two seconds later, at 07:30:31 and 116 kt, the first officer called "roos, roos, on the left". The animals were crossing from the northern side of the runway towards the south. The occurrence notification places them moving onto the runway past the 1,100 m point.

The first officer estimated the range at first sight as around 200 m, and said it could have been less. She described the animals as arriving out of the darkness beyond the lights, already on the sealed surface by the time she registered them. Once they were on the seal, she said, she could see both of them clearly. The captain said he was looking at the engine page after V1 and did not see the animals until her call.

The rejected take-off

At 07:30:32 the captain called "Stopping. I have control." The first officer handed over control. The aircraft was at 118 kt, six knots and 3 seconds past V1. It was 1,152 m along runway 09, with 695 m of sealed surface remaining. Both power levers reached flight idle within 0.6 seconds.

In interview and in his air safety report, the captain acknowledged that the decision to stop was above V1 and outside the procedure. He described his reasoning at the time. If he continued, the aircraft would be airborne at night, with damage he could not assess, over country that offered no usable option.

At 07:30:33, about one second after the reject, the aircraft struck the animals. The flight data recorded a lateral acceleration spike of 0.31 g to the right and a vertical spike of 1.48 g. The right main landing gear and the No. 2 propeller took the impact. The notification and the runway survey both record that both animals were struck, with carcasses recovered 1,188 m and 1,221 m from the runway 09 threshold. The captain described striking at least one.

The stop

Maximum braking was established at 07:30:34, 2 seconds after the decision. Anti-skid was active on all four wheels. That response sits at the fast end of the operator's recorded fleet distribution for rejected take-offs, where the fleet mean is 3.2 seconds.

At 07:30:36 the captain selected reverse and called that number two was not coming. Reverse engaged on No. 1 only. No. 2 propeller RPM had been decaying since the impact, and the No. 2 reverse interlock did not make. From 07:30:34 to 07:30:44 the mean deceleration was 2.6 m/s². That is approximately 15% below the value in the certified accelerate-stop data, which assumes symmetric reverse.

The first officer called the speeds as they fell. At 07:30:47 the captain said, "We're not stopping on it." Two seconds later the first officer called that the end was coming up. The aircraft left the sealed surface at 07:30:51 at approximately 21 kt. In the graded gravel, longitudinal deceleration fell to 1.9 m/s².

At 07:30:57 the aircraft came to rest 62 m into the 90 m runway end safety area. It was upright and on the extended centreline, with the nose wheel in graded gravel. It stopped 28 m short of the end of the prepared area, beyond which the terrain is ungraded. The stopping distance from 118 kt was 757 m. Continuous tyre marks ran from 1,160 m to the runway end, and the nose wheel rut continued to the stopping point.

After the aircraft stopped

The captain set the parking brake. He confirmed that there were no fire indications and nothing on the warning panel, and he decided not to evacuate. Both engines were shut down at 07:31:26. At 07:31:34 the captain told the cabin to remain seated.

When the tower asked for the aircraft's situation, the captain reported the overrun and gave the persons on board. He said no injuries had been reported and there was no fire. He asked the tower

to activate the aerodrome emergency plan and send a vehicle. The tower activated the plan at 07:32:10 and dispatched a vehicle. Aerodrome staff attended, and there was no fire.

Passengers left by the forward airstair onto the ground in a precautionary disembarkation. No evacuation was commanded and no slides were deployed. The CVR captures the airstair operating at 07:34:40. The occurrence notification states that passengers were disembarked 4 minutes 8 seconds after the aircraft stopped. The main cabin lights were on throughout.

The first officer described the disembarkation as calm and orderly. Walking back through the cabin, she noticed two unlit sections of the aisle floor lighting strip towards the rear. The emergency lighting was armed and the ceiling lights were on at the time. She reported this to the engineer the next morning.

Outcome

No serious injuries resulted. One cabin crew member reported bruising during the disembarkation. Both kangaroos were killed.

The aircraft was substantially damaged:

- three No. 2 propeller blades were damaged beyond repairable limits, one with a separated tip, and animal tissue was recovered from two blade roots
- the No. 2 engine required a shock-load inspection
- the right main gear doors were distorted
- both right main tyres had deflated through the fuse plugs, with brake energy at 84% of the certified maximum
- the lower right fuselage was abraded and had two punctures consistent with propeller debris

The aerodrome was closed for 4 hours 20 minutes. Both flight crew were stood down and drug and alcohol tested, and both results were negative. The FDR and CVR were removed at 12:40 UTC. The evening Tarlton Springs service was suspended pending the investigation.

Analysis

Introduction

The aircraft overran runway 09 because two things combined during the stop. The stop began after V1, and the deceleration achieved was below the deceleration the scheduled accelerate-stop figures assume. Both trace back to the same event: two kangaroos on the sealed surface during the take-off roll. One chain runs through the captain's decision to reject. The other runs through the strike on the No. 2 propeller and the right main gear, which removed half of the available reverse thrust about one second into the stop.

Above those events sit the conditions that put the animals on the runway at that time. These were a perimeter fence that had been known to be failed for more than three years, a departure scheduled into the period of peak kangaroo movement and full darkness, and a runway inspection that nobody requested. Above those again sit the procedures, risk controls and standards that left those conditions unaddressed.

This section analyses each factor under the heading it belongs to and states the resulting finding. It distinguishes contributing safety factors from other factors that increased risk without influencing this occurrence. It also discusses one matter that was examined and could not be settled.

People

The decision to reject above V1

The captain called V1 at 07:30:29 at 112 kt. The first officer's sighting call followed two seconds later, at 07:30:31: "Roos - roos, roos, on the left, they're on the -". One second after that the captain called "Stopping. I have control." The flight data shows both power levers retarded to flight idle from 07:30:32 at 118 kt, three seconds and six knots past V1. The whole decision occupied a single exchange on the CVR.

The applicable procedure leaves no ambiguity about speed. Operations Manual Part B 4.6.4 states: "At or above V1 the take-off shall be continued. The decision to continue is made before V1 is reached." The captain acknowledged, in interview and in his air safety report, that the reject was outside that procedure. He explained that he had judged the alternative to be worse. Rotating into two large animals would, in his assessment, have left the aircraft airborne at night with damage he could not assess, over country that offered no usable option. He described the stop as the risk whose end he could see.

The investigation does not treat that reasoning as either right or wrong. Section 4.6 contains no guidance on an obstruction seen on the runway at any speed, and nothing that amplifies 4.6.4 for a case in which continuing is itself hazardous. The captain therefore had a rule that did not address the situation in front of him and about one second to decide. The procedural and training background to the decision is analysed under Procedures below.

The effect of the decision on the stop is a matter of arithmetic. The scheduled accelerate-stop distance required was 1,780 m against an accelerate-stop distance available of 1,847 m. That left a margin of 67 m, on the assumption that the stop begins at or before V1. Distance reconstruction from recorded groundspeed places the aircraft 1,152 m along runway 09 when the reject began, with 695 m of sealed surface remaining. Beginning the stop three seconds and six knots after V1 consumed the 67 m margin and more, before the loss of No. 2 reverse is counted.

The decision was made in response to the animals, which is analysed under Environment, and against a procedural and training background analysed under Procedures. It is a contributing

factor. It is not the only one, and it sits downstream of the conditions that put the animals on the runway.

It is virtually certain that the take-off was rejected at 118 kt, 6 kt above V1, and extremely likely that beginning the stop at that speed contributed to the overrun.

Execution of the rejected take-off

The handling of the stop, once the decision was made, reduced the severity of the outcome. The power levers reached flight idle 0.6 seconds after the decision. Maximum braking was established at 07:30:34, 2 seconds after the decision, against a fleet mean of 3.2 seconds from decision to maximum braking in the operator's own recorded distribution for rejected take-offs. That places the response at the fast end of the fleet's range.

Anti-skid was active on all four wheels throughout. Brake energy reached 84% of the certified maximum for the weight and speed without a brake fire or hydraulic leak. The captain selected reverse at 07:30:36, 4 seconds after the decision, and called "Reverse - number two's not coming. Max brakes, max brakes." Only No. 1 reverse was available, because the No. 2 propeller had been damaged in the strike. The first officer called the speeds as they fell and called the runway end as it approached.

The aircraft left the sealed surface at approximately 21 kt and stopped 62 m into the 90 m runway end safety area. It was upright and on the extended centreline, 28 m short of the end of the prepared area, beyond which the terrain is ungraded. The investigation estimated that a stop begun at the fleet mean response would have carried the aircraft a further 30 to 40 m. That would have placed it close to the far edge of the runway end safety area.

The same investigation that finds the reject was outside procedure therefore also finds that what followed was executed faster than the fleet average. That speed is the margin between a low-speed stop on prepared ground and a departure from the safety area onto ungraded terrain.

It is virtually certain that maximum braking and No. 1 reverse were applied without delay, and very likely that this reduced the severity of the overrun.

The runway inspection that was not requested

Neither the CVR nor the tower's recorded audio contains a request for a runway inspection, an offer of one, or any mention of wildlife before departure. No wildlife transmission appears on the tower channel in the 90 minutes before the take-off clearance. The aerodrome's daily inspection log for 18/06/2026 records a single inspection, at 07:35 local before the first arrival, with the movement area recorded as clear. No further inspection was carried out or requested that day.

An inspection was available for the asking. Aerodrome Manual 6.3 provides for inspections outside the scheduled time at the request of the reporting officer or a pilot in command. The reporting officer confirmed that one would have been carried out if asked. Aerodrome staff disperse animals when they find them.

Both crew members stated that they did not consider requesting one. The captain had expected Tarlton Springs to be on the operator's list of wildlife-active aerodromes in Appendix 8A, and he was surprised to learn it was not. Nothing in the documents either crew member consulted before the flight mentioned wildlife at the aerodrome. The first officer had flown into Tarlton Springs twice before, both times in daylight.

This was an omission without an owner. No procedure asked either pilot to consider an inspection at Tarlton Springs, and no information reached the flight deck that would have prompted the question. The reason the requirement did not apply is analysed under Procedures.

An inspection would have covered the section of runway between the 1,050 m and 1,250 m marks. The animal pad through the fence and both carcasses were found within that section. The effect is not certain. An inspection completed some minutes before the take-off roll cannot guarantee that the runway stays clear until the aircraft passes.

It is virtually certain that no runway inspection was requested before the first departure after last light, and likely that this contributed to the kangaroos being on the sealed surface during the take-off roll.

Crew duty and the late fifth sector

The crew signed on at 06:30 local. The Tarlton Springs departure was their fifth sector, added that morning when the rostered crew reported unfit. The occurrence came 11 hours 00 minutes into a duty planned to run 12 hours 05 minutes, against a limit of 12 hours 30 minutes for five sectors from that sign-on. The aircraft departed 40 minutes behind schedule. Both crew described themselves in interview as tired but not struggling. The captain said he would have declined a further sector, and that he had been alert during the seconds that mattered.

The investigation examined whether the duty affected the occurrence. On one side, 11 hours into a five-sector day is a range in which degraded decision making would be expected, the schedule was running late, and the crew were working towards the end of their day.

On the other side, the recorded data contradicts each mechanism through which fatigue would have had to act. The response from decision to flight idle was 0.6 seconds and the response to maximum braking was 2 seconds, both at the fast end of the fleet's distribution. No error of omission appears during the roll. The one decision the schedule could plausibly have affected was the omitted runway inspection, and that decision was never placed in front of either crew member, because no document prompted them to consider it. A lapse in a step nobody was asked to take cannot be attributed to fatigue.

The exposure remains a concern. The evening Tarlton Springs rotation routinely places the last sector inside the final hour of a 12-hour duty. It does so at an aerodrome with no company engineering support, no alternate within 200 nm at night, and no crewing resilience. A single crew member reporting unfit turns a four-sector day into a five-sector day on the morning of operation. That exposure is built into the schedule and will recur.

It is virtually certain that the crew were operating their fifth sector, 11 hours into duty and 40 minutes behind schedule. It is unlikely that this influenced the occurrence, but likely that it increased risk to the operation.

Environment

Darkness and the timing of the departure

The take-off roll began at 17:30 local. That was 32 minutes after sunset at 16:58 and 5 minutes after the end of civil twilight at 17:25. Moonrise was not until 22:41, and the moon was a waning crescent, 14% illuminated. The aerodrome was in full darkness, with no natural ambient light on the strip and no town lighting within sight. At the same time of day on 23/06/2026, the investigator confirmed on site that the unlit graded strip either side of the sealed surface could not be seen from the runway centreline.

The departure also fell within the period of peak kangaroo movement shown in the aerodrome's own records. The aerodrome wildlife sighting log, a paper register held in the aerodrome office and covering 01/2025 to 06/2026, contains 46 entries. Of these, 41 record kangaroos on or adjacent

to the movement area, and 38 of those 41 are timed between one hour before and two hours after last light. The log is a paper register, so its completeness could not be verified.

The two conditions worked together. The timing placed the departure in the window when kangaroos were most likely to be on or near the movement area. The darkness meant that any animal on the strip could not be seen until it reached the lit sealed surface. The first officer's account at 07:32:35 is consistent with that: "They came out of the dark on the left of the strip, crossed the centreline. I had them for - I don't know, two seconds. Maybe less. There was nothing to see and then there were two of them."

On its own, a departure after last light is unremarkable. It matters here because it removed any chance of seeing the animals early, and because it is the condition that made the missing runway inspection significant.

It is extremely likely that the departure took place in the hour after last light, within the peak period of kangaroo movement recorded at the aerodrome, and likely that this contributed to the kangaroos being on the sealed surface undetected during the take-off roll.

Kangaroos on the sealed surface

Two adult kangaroos were recovered from runway 09, on the northern half, at 1,188 m and 1,221 m from the threshold. The first officer saw them crossing from the northern side towards the south and estimated their range at first sight as around 200 m. Her call at 07:30:31 is on the CVR, and the impact is recorded at 07:30:33. Each of these sources establishes the presence of the animals on its own.

The route by which they reached the runway is shown by the position of the carcasses relative to the fence. The site inspection found a clear animal pad through the failed northern fence at the 1,050 m mark. That is 138 m before the first carcass and on the same side of the runway. The sighting log records eleven entries of animals on the sealed surface of runway 09/27. The condition of the fence is analysed under Organisation.

The animals being on the surface is the event from which both causal chains proceed. The captain rejected the take-off in response to them, and the aircraft struck them about one second later.

It is virtually certain that two kangaroos entered the runway strip and moved onto the sealed surface, and extremely likely that this contributed to the overrun through both the rejected take-off and the strike.

Runway edge lighting intensity (unresolved)

The investigation examined whether the intensity of the runway edge lighting reduced the crew's ability to detect the animals. The matter could not be settled. It is not a finding either way.

The intensity deviation itself is not in doubt. A photometric check carried out at the investigator's request on 25/06/2026 found four runway 09/27 edge lights on the northern side, between the 900 m and 1,200 m markers, at between 118% and 131% of nominal intensity for stage 3. The remaining lights were within tolerance. Those four lights were in the section the animals crossed. The aerodrome operator's maintenance programme checks lamp serviceability but does not measure intensity.

The question examined was whether that deviation reduced the crew's ability to see an animal approaching or on the runway. The evidence bearing on that question pointed in both directions.

In support, the captain recalled the lighting as brighter than he would have wanted. He described a corridor of light with everything outside it black, and said that nothing approaching from off the

sealed surface could be seen coming. The measured over-intensity lay in the same section of runway as the animals' crossing.

Against it, the first officer, who did see the animals, described the lighting as normal. She said that once the animals were on the sealed surface she saw them clearly, at around 200 m. She also acknowledged that, with only two daylight visits to compare against, she was not well placed to judge whether the lighting was unusual. The captain's account is weaker evidence on detection, because he was looking at the engine page after V1, as the procedure required. His not seeing the animals is explained by where his attention properly was, without any need to invoke the lighting.

Three gaps prevented a conclusion. The photometric check was made seven days after the occurrence, and nothing records the intensity of the lights on the night. The two crew accounts of the lighting disagree, and both are honestly given. No study was available that links an edge light at 131% of nominal to the detection of an object on the runway surface. The measurement establishes a deviation, but no available evidence establishes an effect.

Resolving the question would require evidence of the lighting's actual intensity on the night, together with evidence linking that intensity to the detectability of an object on or beside the sealed surface. Neither was available. This matter remains unresolved and is not carried into the findings.

Equipment

The strike and the loss of No. 2 reverse

The aircraft struck the animals at 07:30:33 at 114 kt, one second after the reject began. The flight data recorded a lateral acceleration spike of 0.31 g to the right and a vertical spike of 1.48 g. The first officer reported at 07:30:34 that they had taken one on the propeller.

The physical evidence ties the damage to the strike. Three No. 2 propeller blades were damaged beyond repairable limits, with leading edge deformation and one blade tip separated. Animal tissue was recovered from two blade roots. The right main gear doors were distorted by the impact. The lower right fuselage skin was abraded and had two punctures consistent with propeller debris. No. 2 propeller RPM decays from the moment of impact, and the No. 2 reverse interlock did not make.

The significance of the strike lies in its effect on the stop as much as in the damage. It removed one of the two reverse units about one second into a stop that had already lost its scheduled margin. When the captain selected reverse at 07:30:36, only No. 1 responded. For the remainder of the stop the aircraft decelerated on wheel brakes and asymmetric reverse.

It is virtually certain that the No. 2 propeller and right main gear struck two kangaroos, and virtually certain that the resulting loss of No. 2 reverse contributed to the reduced deceleration.

Deceleration against the scheduled accelerate-stop performance

The two causal chains converge at the deceleration achieved, and the analysis treats them as a single mechanism. The scheduled accelerate-stop figures assume that the stop begins at or before V1 and that reverse is symmetric. Neither assumption held.

The mean deceleration recorded between 07:30:34 and 07:30:44 was 2.6 m/s². That is approximately 15% below the value used in the certified accelerate-stop data for this weight and runway condition. When the aircraft entered the graded gravel at 07:30:51, longitudinal deceleration fell to 1.9 m/s². The stopping distance achieved from 118 kt was 757 m against 695 m of sealed surface remaining. The difference is the 62 m the aircraft travelled into the runway end safety area.

The investigation assessed that both contributions were needed to carry the aircraft past the runway end, and that neither the late start nor the reduced deceleration would have done so alone. The 62 m overrun is the product of a stop begun 6 kt late with about 15% less deceleration than the scheduled figures assume.

The evidence does not point to any other source of the shortfall. The anti-skid system tested serviceable after the occurrence. Brake energy reached 84% of the certified maximum without failure. The right main gear structure was within limits on detailed inspection. Both right main tyres deflated through the fuse plugs, consistent with brake energy. The recorded data, the distance reconstruction and the tyre marks running continuously from 1,160 m to the runway end all agree.

It is virtually certain that the deceleration achieved was below the scheduled accelerate-stop performance, and virtually certain that this shortfall contributed to the overrun.

Cabin floor proximity emergency lighting

As she walked back through the cabin during the disembarkation, the first officer noticed sections of the aisle floor lighting strip unlit towards the rear. A functional check on 24/06/2026, with the emergency lighting system armed and the aircraft on battery power, found two of the six floor proximity escape path segments dark. Both were on the left side aft of row 16. The fault was traced to a failed ballast common to both segments.

The defect could not have been detected in service. The pre-flight emergency lighting test on this type illuminates the ceiling emergency lights and the exit signs. It does not illuminate or monitor the floor proximity segments. Neither the crew nor a line engineer could detect the fault without a dedicated functional test. The last such test was 11 months before the occurrence, within the maintenance programme's 24-month interval.

The defect had no bearing on this occurrence. No evacuation was commanded. The disembarkation was conducted by the forward airstair, unhurried, with the main cabin lights on throughout, and it was completed without incident.

The defect nonetheless matters. In a different occurrence, with a fire indication, smoke, or a night evacuation over the wing, two dark segments in the aft cabin could be the difference between an orderly exit and a blocked one. The more significant problem is the monitoring regime. A 24-month functional interval on a system that the daily test cannot see means that a failure can persist undetected for most of that interval. The same ballast is fitted across the type, and the condition of the escape path lighting across the rest of the fleet was not known.

It is virtually certain that the cabin floor proximity emergency lighting was partially unserviceable. It is unlikely that this influenced the occurrence, but very likely that it increased risk to occupants in an evacuation (Safety Issue).

Procedures

The trigger for a runway inspection

The operator had a defence aimed at exactly this occurrence. Operations Manual Part A 8.14.2 states that "At an aerodrome listed in Appendix 8A, the pilot in command shall request a runway inspection from the aerodrome operator prior to the first departure after last light, and shall not commence the take-off roll until the result of that inspection has been passed." Had that requirement applied at Tarlton Springs, the inspection discussed under People would have been requested, and the take-off roll would have waited for its result.

It did not apply, because of how an aerodrome gets onto the list. Appendix 8A states that "An aerodrome is listed in this appendix where a wildlife strike involving a company aircraft has been

reported at that aerodrome within the preceding 24 months." For any aerodrome not listed, 8.14.3 provides that "no specific action is required. Crews should remain alert to the possibility of wildlife on the movement area."

On 18/06/2026 Appendix 8A listed nine aerodromes. Tarlton Springs was not among them and had never been listed. No provision in Part A asks a crew to report a wildlife sighting, and no provision admits an aerodrome to the list on any evidence other than a reported strike. The list was last reviewed on 03/03/2025, about four months before the evening service began on 14/07/2025.

The control was therefore conditional on the outcome it existed to prevent. Tarlton Springs had had no company strike, so it could not be listed. Because it was not listed, no inspection was required. Because no inspection was required, nobody looked for animals on the runway.

Meanwhile, the information that would have identified the hazard existed at the aerodrome. Its sighting log held eleven entries of kangaroos on the sealed surface of runway 09/27. The log was not reported to any operator, and the aerodrome reporting officer confirmed that no airline had ever asked for it. Under the listing criterion, none of that information could have placed the aerodrome on the list, because none of it was a strike.

The inspection requirement itself is sound. The weakness is in the trigger. Had the requirement applied, an inspection would very likely have found and dispersed the animals. The remaining doubt reflects only that a runway inspected some minutes before departure may not stay clear until the roll.

It is virtually certain that the operator's procedures required a runway inspection only at aerodromes listed in Appendix 8A, with a reported strike as the only criterion for listing. It is very likely that this contributed to no inspection being requested before the departure (Safety Issue).

Rejected take-off guidance and training

Part B 4.6 sets the frame for rejected take-off decisions. Below 80 kt the take-off is to be rejected for any malfunction or condition that makes the aircraft unfit to fly. Between 80 kt and V1, 4.6.3 limits the reasons to fire or fire warning, engine failure, a configuration warning, loss of directional control, or the pilot in command's judgement that the aircraft is unsafe or unable to fly. At or above V1, the take-off is to be continued. The section contains no guidance on an obstruction seen on the runway at any speed.

The recurrent training matches the manual. The objective of module 4 of TRG-SYL-07 is that "the crew will demonstrate a correctly executed rejected take-off for an engine failure, an engine fire and a configuration warning, each initiated below V1, and will demonstrate the decision to continue for a failure recognised at or after V1." Its four scripted simulator scenarios are an engine failure at 90 kt, an engine fire at 100 kt, a configuration warning at 85 kt, and an engine failure at V1 plus 5 kt, continued. All four are aircraft system events, and three occur below V1.

In the 2025 to 2026 cycle, 214 crew completed module 4. No crew has been presented with an external obstruction scenario in the five training cycles held by the operator. Both the captain and the first officer stated independently, and in almost the same terms, that every stop or go scenario they had been given had been an engine event arriving below V1.

Whether this gap influenced the reject was argued, and the investigation carries both readings.

The first reading is that the captain faced a decision he had never rehearsed. He had about one second after the sighting call and no briefed or practised frame to decide against. The training system exists so that a decision of that kind is not made for the first time on the runway. An unrehearsed decision, made cold in that time, is not the same decision as one made against a framework the pilot has practised.

The second reading rests on the captain's own account. He knew the rule and departed from it deliberately, because he judged continuing to be the worse risk. Training in obstructions would not have changed what he knew. On that reading, the training gap is a finding about the fleet's preparedness rather than a cause of this particular reject.

On balance, the investigation accepted the first reading at the level of likely, not higher. The training gap explains the circumstances of the decision. It does not excuse the decision, and it does not establish that a crew trained in obstructions would have continued.

It is extremely likely that rejected take-off training covered aircraft system failures below V1 only, and likely that this contributed to the decision to reject the take-off above V1.

Organisation

The aerodrome wildlife standard threshold

Aerodrome Standard AS-139 10.4.1 requires the operator of a certified aerodrome to "take reasonable measures to reduce the risk to aircraft operations presented by wildlife on or in the vicinity of the aerodrome." A documented wildlife hazard management plan is required under 10.4.2 only where the aerodrome "is used by aeroplanes having a maximum take-off weight exceeding 27,000 kg, or serves more than 350,000 passenger movements in a calendar year." Where 10.4.2 does not apply, 10.4.3 provides that the measures "need not be documented, but the aerodrome operator must be able to demonstrate what measures are in place."

Tarlton Springs falls below both limbs. Its heaviest scheduled aeroplane is the 22,900 kg twin-turboprop used on the Saltbush Air service, and it handled 61,400 passenger movements in 2025. It accordingly held no wildlife hazard management plan, no hazard assessment and no dispersal programme. It held no record of wildlife measures beyond the single inspection before the first arrival under Aerodrome Manual 6.3. This was confirmed against the certified aerodrome register and the aerodrome operator's own compliance file. The aerodrome was not in breach of the standard.

The point is therefore about the standard's threshold rather than the aerodrome's compliance. Below that threshold, an aerodrome of this size is left with a wildlife programme that is undocumented, unaudited and, in practice, unfunded.

The influence of the threshold on this occurrence was argued, and the conclusion is less firm than the other influence findings in this analysis.

In support, a documented plan was the one mechanism that would have connected the aerodrome's sighting log to the operators using the aerodrome. It was also the one mechanism that would have moved the failed fence from an unfunded works register onto a funded programme. A documented plan brings an audit trail and an owner, and each of the other controls in this occurrence failed for want of exactly those.

Against it, 10.4.1 still obliged the aerodrome operator to take reasonable measures, and a documented plan is not the only way to repair a fence or pass a sighting log to an airline. The deferrals of the fence repair were budget decisions. There is no evidence that a documented plan would have attracted funding any more successfully. A plan is a document, and the fence repair needed money.

On the balance of that evidence, the investigation accepted the influence at the level of likely.

It is virtually certain that AS-139 required a documented wildlife hazard management plan only above a size threshold that Tarlton Springs does not meet. It is likely that this contributed to the

fence remaining unrepaired and to the absence of any trigger for runway inspections at the aerodrome (Safety Issue).

The deferred perimeter fence repair

The failure of the northern perimeter fence was known to the aerodrome operator for more than three years before the occurrence. Works register item WR-221, raised in 04/2023, recorded four displaced panels and strained wire on the northern boundary between the 700 m and 1,300 m runway markers. It recorded that animals had been observed passing through and recommended replacement at an estimated \$41,000.

The item was deferred at the 2023, 2024 and 2025 budget rounds. Each deferral was recorded as unfunded, for review at the next cycle. Item WR-263, raised in 02/2026, recorded the same section as deteriorating further.

The investigator's site inspection on 23/06/2026 found a continuous 140 m section of the northern fence with the bottom two wires separated from the posts. A clear animal pad ran through it at the 1,050 m mark (Figure 1). The pad is 138 m before the first carcass at 1,188 m, on the same side of the runway. It is also consistent with the first officer's observation of the animals crossing from the northern side.



Figure 1: The northern perimeter fence at the 1,050 m mark, photographed on the site visit: the fallen section and the animal pad through it. Site inspection photograph SV-2026-0417-07, northern boundary at the 1,050 m runway marker, taken 23/06/2026

Nothing about the fence's condition had to be reconstructed. It is recorded in the aerodrome operator's own register, including the observation in 2023 that animals were passing through. A fence in that condition does not exclude kangaroos, and the pad through the breach lies directly

upstream of the strike position. The fence was the physical route by which the animals reached the movement area. It is also the one factor in this occurrence that a single works item would have addressed directly.

It is virtually certain that repair of the northern perimeter fence was deferred for three budget cycles, and very likely that this contributed to the kangaroos entering the runway strip and moving onto the sealed surface (Safety Issue).

Introduction of the evening service

The operator's current route risk assessment for Tarlton Springs is RRA-041 issue 3, dated 11/2022. It assessed hazards that included runway length and accelerate-stop margin, a single runway with no lighting redundancy, and the absence of an alternate within 200 nm at night. It carries the operating restriction "daylight operations only pending review of night lighting and diversion fuel policy." No issue 4 exists.

Change Management Record CMR-2025-118 introduced the evening service. Its scope was "addition of one evening rotation, Sydney to Tarlton Springs to Sydney, six days per week, from 14/07/2025." It assessed the change as "schedule change only. Existing aerodrome, existing aircraft type, existing crew qualifications, existing engineering support arrangements. No new hazard identified." Against "Route risk assessment review required" it recorded "No." The Head of Flying Operations approved it on 22/05/2025. The Safety Department's records show no involvement beyond receipt of the approved record.

The change introduced the first scheduled company operation into Tarlton Springs after last light. It did so while a current restriction limited the aerodrome to daylight operations. CMR-2025-118 does not reference that restriction anywhere, and RRA-041 was not reopened. The process asked whether the aerodrome, aircraft, crew and support were new. It did not ask whether the existing route risk assessment still held for the operation proposed.

Why the change was assessed in that way could not be established. The approver has left the company and could not be interviewed. The investigation therefore draws no conclusion about what was considered at the time of approval, and its finding concerns the process and its outcome rather than anyone's intent.

The influence of the change on the occurrence rests on what a review would have found. A review of RRA-041 against a night operation would likely have reached the aerodrome's wildlife exposure and the question of its Appendix 8A status in the same pass. That is not certain. A review might have addressed only lighting and diversion fuel, which are the matters the restriction names. The approver could also not be asked what information was in front of him.

It is virtually certain that the evening service was approved as a schedule change without reopening the route risk assessment, and likely that this contributed to the absence of any requirement for a runway inspection before the departure (Safety Issue).

Excluded hypotheses

Two hypotheses were examined and ruled out.

The first was that the take-off was commenced with a tailwind above limits, which the overrun distance invited as a question. The aerodrome observations at 06:30, 07:00 and 08:00 UTC gave winds of 090 at 7, 6 and 5 kt, a headwind component on runway 09. The recorded wind at the aircraft gave a headwind component of 4 to 6 kt throughout the roll, with no tailwind component at any point. The crew's performance calculation used a 5 kt headwind, consistent with both. It is very unlikely that a tailwind existed at any stage of the roll.

The second was that the No. 2 engine lost power during the take-off roll, which is the most common reason for a high-speed reject. Both engines were at 98.4% and 98.5% torque, within 0.1% of each other, from power set at 07:30:02 until the power levers were retarded at 07:30:32. Fuel flow, ITT and propeller RPM on both engines were within normal scatter throughout, and no caution, warning or exceedance was recorded before the reject. The CVR contains no engine-related call, and the captain's first words after the sighting call were "Stopping. I have control." The borescope of both engines found no pre-existing damage and no evidence of a power anomaly before the impact. The No. 2 propeller damage and RPM decay both begin at 07:30:33, one second after the reject, at the moment of impact. It is very unlikely that a No. 2 engine power loss occurred before the reject. The loss of No. 2 was a consequence of the strike, not a cause of the decision to stop.

Findings summary

A finding stated without a likelihood term was established as fact.

Contributing factors

- It was virtually certain that Aerodrome Standard AS-139 10.4.2 required a documented wildlife hazard management plan only above a size threshold that Tarlton Springs Aerodrome did not meet, and it was likely that this threshold contributed to the occurrence by leaving the aerodrome's wildlife measures without a documented plan, an audit trail or an owner. (Safety Issue)
- The repair of the failed northern perimeter fence was deferred for three budget cycles, which was virtually certain, and the deferral very likely contributed to the occurrence by leaving open the route through which the kangaroos reached the runway strip. (Safety Issue)
- SB512 very likely departed in the hour after last light, the period of peak kangaroo movement recorded at the aerodrome, and departing in that light condition likely contributed to the occurrence.
- Change management record CMR-2025-118 approved the evening Tarlton Springs service as a schedule change only and did not reopen route risk assessment RRA-041 or its daylight-only restriction, which was virtually certain, and the approval likely contributed to the occurrence. (Safety Issue)
- With virtual certainty, Operations Manual Part A 8.14 required a runway inspection before the first departure after last light only at aerodromes listed in Appendix 8A, and the only criterion for listing was a reported strike, and this arrangement very likely contributed to the occurrence because Tarlton Springs had never been listed. (Safety Issue)
- It was virtually certain that no runway inspection was requested before the first departure after last light, and it was likely that the absence of an inspection contributed to the kangaroos being on the sealed surface during the take-off roll.
- Two kangaroos entered the runway strip and moved onto the sealed surface of runway 09, which was virtually certain, and their presence very likely contributed to both the rejected take-off and the strike.
- Recurrent training syllabus TRG-SYL-07 module 4 very likely covered rejected take-offs for aircraft system failures below V1 only, and the absence of any preparation for an obstruction on the runway likely contributed to the decision to reject above V1. (Safety Issue)
- The take-off was rejected at 118 kt, 6 kt above V1, which was virtually certain, and beginning the stop after V1 very likely contributed to the overrun.
- It was virtually certain both that the No. 2 propeller and right main gear struck two kangaroos and that the strike contributed to the overrun, because it removed No. 2 reverse about one second into the stop.
- The deceleration achieved was below the scheduled accelerate-stop performance with virtual certainty, at a mean of 2.6 m/s², approximately 15% below the certified value, and it was virtually certain that this shortfall contributed to the overrun.

Other factors that increased risk

- With virtual certainty, two of the six cabin floor proximity emergency lighting segments aft of row 16 on the left side were unserviceable because of a failed common ballast that

the pre-flight test could not detect, and it was very likely that this partially unserviceable escape path increased risk to occupants, although it did not contribute to the overrun or its outcome. (Safety Issue)

- SB512 was the crew's fifth sector, flown 11 hours into duty and 40 minutes behind schedule, which was virtually certain, and it was likely that this exposure built into the evening Tarlton Springs rotation increased risk, although the recorded data did not support fatigue as a contributor to this occurrence.

Other findings

- The hypothesis that the take-off commenced with a tailwind above limits was examined and ruled out, because the aerodrome observations and the recorded aircraft data both showed a headwind component throughout the roll.
- The hypothesis of a No. 2 engine power loss during the take-off roll was examined and ruled out, because both engines remained within 0.1% torque of each other with no caution, warning or exceedance until the reject, and the No. 2 propeller RPM decay began at the moment of impact.
- Maximum braking and No. 1 reverse were applied without delay, with maximum braking established 2 seconds after the decision against a fleet mean of 3.2 seconds, and this very likely reduced the distance the aircraft travelled into the runway end safety area.

Appendices

Appendix A: Factor test summary

Each factor was tested in up to three stages. The first stage asked whether the factor existed, and the second asked whether it influenced the occurrence. Where a factor did not influence the occurrence, a third stage asked whether it was still important to safety. A factor that passed the first two stages is a contributing factor. A factor that failed the second stage but passed the third is an other factor that increased risk. Where a stage was not needed, the table shows it as not tested. One matter was examined but could not be settled, so it appears in the table as unresolved. No finding was drawn from it.

Factor	Lane	Existence	Influence	Importance	Category
Documented wildlife plan required only above a size threshold the aerodrome does not meet	External Influences	Pass, virtually certain	Pass, likely	Not tested	Contributing factor (Safety Issue)
Perimeter fence repair deferred for three budget cycles	Organisational Influences	Pass, virtually certain	Pass, very likely	Not tested	Contributing factor (Safety Issue)
Evening service approved as a schedule change, route risk assessment not reopened	Organisational Influences	Pass, virtually certain	Pass, likely	Not tested	Contributing factor (Safety Issue)
Runway inspection required only at listed aerodromes, and the listing criterion is a strike	Risk Controls	Pass, virtually certain	Pass, very likely	Not tested	Contributing factor (Safety Issue)
Rejected take-off training covers aircraft system failures below V1 only	Risk Controls	Pass, extremely likely	Pass, likely	Not tested	Contributing factor (Safety Issue)
Departure in the hour after last light, the peak of kangaroo movement	Local Conditions	Pass, extremely likely	Pass, likely	Not tested	Contributing factor
No runway inspection requested before the first departure after last light	Individual Actions	Pass, virtually certain	Pass, likely	Not tested	Contributing factor
Two kangaroos entered the runway strip and moved onto the sealed surface	Occurrence Events	Pass, virtually certain	Pass, extremely likely	Not tested	Contributing factor
Take-off rejected 6 kt above V1	Individual Actions	Pass, virtually certain	Pass, extremely likely	Not tested	Contributing factor
No. 2 propeller and right main gear struck two kangaroos	Occurrence Events	Pass, virtually certain	Pass, virtually certain	Not tested	Contributing factor

Deceleration achieved below the scheduled accelerate-stop performance	Occurrence Events	Pass, virtually certain	Pass, virtually certain	Not tested	Contributing factor
Cabin floor proximity emergency lighting partially unserviceable	Risk Controls	Pass, virtually certain	Fail, unlikely	Pass, very likely	Other factor that increased risk (Safety Issue)
Fifth sector, 11 hours into duty, 40 minutes behind schedule	Local Conditions	Pass, virtually certain	Fail, unlikely	Pass, likely	Other factor that increased risk
Maximum braking and No. 1 reverse applied without delay	Individual Actions	Pass, virtually certain	Pass, very likely (a decrease in risk)	Not tested	Positive event (other finding)
Take-off commenced with a tailwind above limits	Local Conditions	Fail, very unlikely	Not tested	Not tested	Excluded hypothesis
No. 2 engine power loss during the take-off roll	Occurrence Events	Fail, very unlikely	Not tested	Not tested	Excluded hypothesis
Runway edge lighting intensity reduced the crew's ability to detect the animals	Local Conditions	Inconclusive, about as likely as not	Not tested	Not tested	Unresolved, no finding drawn

The likelihood terms in this table are the terms recorded for each test. Two influence results recorded as extremely likely appear as very likely in the findings, because the findings use a narrower scale.

Appendix B: Excluded hypotheses

Take-off commenced with a tailwind above limits

This hypothesis was tested because the aircraft stopped 62 m past the end of the runway, and an overrun of that size invites a question about the wind. It was ruled out. The aerodrome observations at 06:30, 07:00 and 08:00 UTC gave the wind as 090 at 7 kt, 090 at 6 kt and 090 at 5 kt, a headwind component of 5 to 7 kt on runway 09. The recorded FDR wind during the roll agreed, giving a headwind component of 4 to 6 kt throughout with no tailwind component at any point. The crew's performance entry used a 5 kt headwind, which matched both sources. Because no source showed a tailwind at any stage of the roll, the wind did not contribute to the overrun.

No. 2 engine power loss during the take-off roll

This hypothesis was tested because a rejected take-off at 118 kt is most commonly an engine event. It too was ruled out. From power set at 07:30:02 until the power levers were retarded at 07:30:32, the FDR recorded both engines at 98.4% and 98.5% torque, within 0.1% of each other. Fuel flow, ITT and propeller RPM on both engines stayed inside normal scatter throughout. No caution, warning or exceedance was recorded before the reject.

The other evidence pointed the same way. The CVR contains no engine-related call, and the captain's first words were "Stopping, I have control", one second after the first officer's sighting call. A borescope inspection of both engines found no pre-existing damage. The No. 2 propeller damage and the No. 2 RPM decay both began at 07:30:33, at the moment of impact and after the reject had begun. The No. 2 power loss was therefore a consequence of the strike, not a cause of the reject.

Appendix C: Sources of evidence

Interviews and accounts

The pilot in command and the first officer were each interviewed. Both interviews were recorded and were completed by 26/06/2026. In addition, the captain gave an account of the decision to reject in his air safety report. During the site visit on 23/06/2026, the aerodrome reporting officer confirmed that no operator had ever asked to see the wildlife sighting log. The reporting officer also confirmed that a runway inspection would have been carried out if one had been requested. [NOT ESTABLISHED: the individual dates of the two crew interviews, and whether any other person was formally interviewed]

Recorded data and audio

- Flight Data Section report FDA-2026-0417-R1, issued 24/06/2026 (FDR and QAR readout, VH-SBQ, sector SB512)
- CVR-2026-0417 and tower recorded audio, 07:29 to 07:34 UTC, transcribed 25/06/2026 and verified by a second investigator

Aircraft and aerodrome examination

- Engineering inspection report, VH-SBQ, 19/06/2026 to 21/06/2026 (post-occurrence aircraft inspection and runway survey)
- Functional check record, VH-SBQ cabin emergency lighting, 24/06/2026
- Photometric check, Tarlton Springs runway 09/27 edge lighting, 25/06/2026
- Site inspection photograph SV-2026-0417-07, northern boundary at the 1,050 m runway marker, taken 23/06/2026. Its caption reads "The northern perimeter fence at the 1,050 m mark, photographed on the site visit: the fallen section and the animal pad through it" (attachments/Perimeter_fence_repair_deferred_for_three_budget_cycles_1.jpg).

Aerodrome documents

- Tarlton Springs Aerodrome wildlife sighting log, 01/2025 to 06/2026, copied 23/06/2026
- Tarlton Shire Council aerodrome works register items WR-221 (04/2023) and WR-263 (02/2026), with the 23/06/2026 site inspection
- Aerodrome daily inspection log, 18/06/2026
- Aerodrome Manual 6.3
- Certified aerodrome register and the aerodrome operator's compliance file

Operator documents

- Saltbush Air Operations Manual Part A section 8.14, revision 9, 04/2024, and Appendix 8A
- Saltbush Air Operations Manual Part B section 4.6, revision 14, 09/2025
- Recurrent training syllabus TRG-SYL-07, cycle 2025 to 2026, module 4
- Route Risk Assessment RRA-041 issue 3 (11/2022)
- Change Management Record CMR-2025-118 (approved 22/05/2025)
- Flight crew records and duty record, 18/06/2026

Regulatory and environmental sources

- Aerodrome Standard AS-139 section 10.4, wildlife hazard management
- MET-ARCH-SB512-180626, retrieved 19/06/2026 (weather observations, forecast, and light and moon data)

Appendix D: Investigation activity

- 18/06/2026, 09:05 UTC: The Duty Operations Controller notified the investigator. The occurrence was assessed as a serious incident warranting investigation, and the investigation was opened with its scope documented.
- 19/06/2026, 01:20 UTC: The recorders were logged as removed at Tarlton Springs and dispatched to the flight data section. Both crew members were stood down and tested, with negative results. The Head of Flying Operations suspended the evening Tarlton Springs service.
- 23/06/2026, 08:40 UTC: The investigator visited Tarlton Springs. The northern fence was walked and photographed, which found a continuous 140 m failure and an animal pad at the 1,050 m mark. The wildlife sighting log was copied, and a photometric check of the runway 09/27 edge lighting was requested.
- 26/06/2026, 04:15 UTC: The interviews with the pilot in command and the first officer were completed. The cabin emergency lighting functional check was raised from the first officer's account.
- 02/07/2026, 06:30 UTC: The Appendix 8A listing criterion was confirmed as self-referential. Only a reported strike at an aerodrome could list it, and no provision asked a crew to report a sighting. The matter was raised with the operator's Safety Department.

Distribution

Title	Name
Head of Flying Operations	R. Calvert
Head of Safety	M. Falkiner
Fleet Manager, Turboprop	D. Osei
Training Manager	S. Arnott
Aerodrome Reporting Officer, Tarlton Springs	K. Pryor